

France — EU Blue Card

The multi-year talent card for senior salaried professionals

Eligibility

Salary	€59,373 gross per year — 1.5x the reference average gross annual salary
Qualification	Diploma covering 3 years of higher education, OR 5 years' experience at a comparable level
Listed professions	3 years' experience acquired within the previous 7 years
Contract	At least 6 months

No discounted rate and no age concession. The threshold is indexed — confirm the figure on the day the contract is signed.

Card length

Contract 2 years or more	Card matches the contract, capped at 4 years
Contract under 2 years	Contract plus 3 months, capped at 2 years

Mobility and family

EU mobility	After 1 year on a Blue Card elsewhere in the EU; file within 1 month of entering France
Second move	Qualifying period falls to 6 months
Family	Spouse and minor children receive a talent-famille card — no reunification procedure

Procedure

Fees	€300 residence card tax plus €50 stamp duty
Implicit refusal	Prefecture silence for 90 days (30 days if you hold a Blue Card elsewhere)
French required	Not for the card; B2 applies only at naturalisation

If the offer is below the threshold

Alternative	Salaried role at a jeune entreprise innovante or a ministry-recognised innovative company, from €39,582 gross
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Worth checking before an offer is negotiated rather than after it is signed.